social cost of the structural adjustment had hit the developing countries hard. It is the developed countries that derived the greatest benefits from the existing structure of the world economy. Therefore, they found it unacceptable that the rich and the powerful nations should continue to establish unilateral conditionalities on open trade to gain advantages from the countries constituting the Movement. While pressing for opening up of the economies of the developing countries, developed countries imposed restrictions and tariff obstructions on the products of the developing countries in their own country. Thus, the Movement expressed grave concern over the new protectionism of the developed countries.

Twelfth NAM Summit, Durban (South Africa), 2–3 September 1998

The NAM countries met at Durban, South Africa from 2 to 3 September 1998, to address crucial global issues affecting their people with a view to agreeing to a set of actions in the promotion of peace, security and development, conducive to a new system of international relations based on the principles of justice, equality and democracy.

There was a wide array of issues discussed in this summit. While reviewing the international situation and the role of NAM, the member countries discussed matters relating to agenda for peace, strengthening and democratization of the United Nations, disarmament, terrorism, and a host of other issues. They expressed their concern at the slow pace of progress towards nuclear disarmament, which constitutes their primary disarmament objective. They further stressed the significance of universal adherence to the CTBT, including adherence by all nuclear weapon states, and commencement of negotiations in the Conference on disarmament of fissile materials, which, interalia, should accelerate the process of nuclear disarmament. They also reiterated their positions against unilateral, coercive or discriminatory measures, which have been applied against the non-aligned countries. They stressed the need for bilateral dialogue to secure peaceful solutions on all outstanding issues and the promotion of confidence and security-building measures and mutual trust.